



Above Astonishing Baroque stonework supports the balconies of the Palazzo Nicolaci di Villadorata in Noto



Above Glorious Sicilian lemons are used to make sorbet, a palate-cleansing contrast to the wealth of creamy, rich *gelati* flavors

Three Days in the Val di Noto

The old cities of the Val di Noto boast an exceptional artistic and cultural heritage. But this small corner of the island is also known for its dramatic, fertile interior landscape and stunning coastal scenery.

DAY ONE Visit the Baroque cathedral of **San Nicolò** in Noto and explore the nearby **palazzi** (palaces). After lunch, head inland to **Noto Antico** (old Noto) and wander around this atmospheric “ghost town.”

DAY TWO Jump in a car or taxi and head south out of town, through the agricultural and wine-producing center of **Pachino** and onward toward **Capo Passero** – Sicily’s southernmost headland. Here you can spend time in the charming seaside town of **Portopalo**, and enjoy the view of the lighthouse from **Capo delle Correnti**.

DAY THREE To the north of Noto in the **Monti Iblei**, deep river valleys have shaped the plateau housing the wonderful ancient site of **Pantalica**, where a scattering of tombs are smothered by wild flowers in spring. Below, the shady **Anapo River** can be followed on foot along the track of the former railroad.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Sicily’s main **airport** is Catania Fontanarossa. There are **buses** to Noto from the airport and there is a single-track **railway** from Noto to Ragusa, Modica, and Scicli. A **rental car** is useful for exploring the area and the island.

WHERE TO STAY

Agriturismo Calamosche (inexpensive) is a simple place with rooms and a campsite, 6 miles (10 km) outside Noto. +39 347 858 7319

La Fontanella (moderate) is Noto’s only central hotel, located in a 19th-century palazzo.

www.albergolafontanella.it

Terre di Vendicari (expensive), a stylish country house, lies in a nature preserve south of Noto.

www.terredivendicari.it

TOURIST INFORMATION

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